Fix: The Specified Domain Either Does Not Exist or Not Contact

By Vega | Follow | Last Updated December 8, 2023

English

When you try to connect to join a domain on any Windows operating system or after entering a username and correct password, you may receive an error with the message
"**the specified domain either does not exist or could not be contacted**". Well, this article from MiniTool Partition Wizard shows you several ways to fix it.

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This "**the specified domain does not exist or could not be contacted**" error is usually due to invalid DNS settings on the workstation, as Active Directory requires domain DNS (not the router's address) to function properly. The error can also occur because IPv6 does not work.

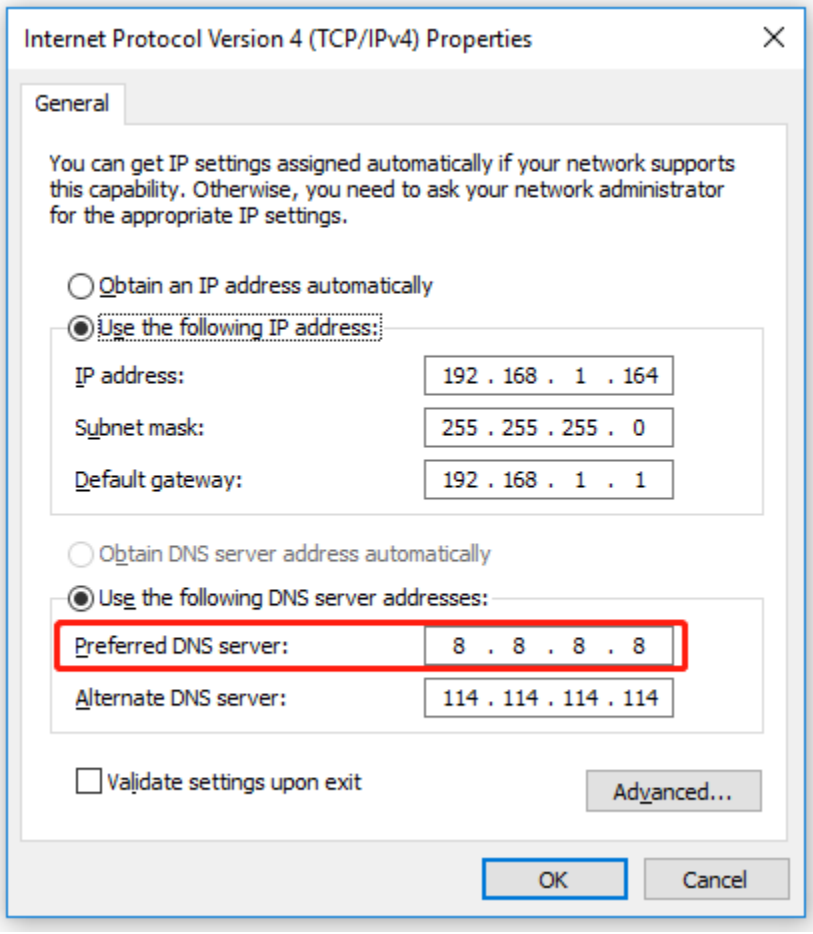
Well, how to fix the
"the specified domain either does not exist or could not be contacted" error? Please keep reading.

Before trying the solutions below, if you have IPv6 configured, you can disable the protocol and then release TCP/IP, and flush DNS, which may resolve DNS issues on Windows 11/10.

Way 1: Change the DNS Server Address

To resolve the "
the specified domain either does not exist or could not be contacted " error, you should set the preferred DNS IP to point to the IP address of the primary domain controller on each client workstation that is joining the domain. To do so, here is the guide.

Step 1: Press the **Win + R** key to open the **Run** box. Then type **ncpa.cpl** in it and press **Enter** to open the Network Connections control panel.
Step 2: Right-click the **local area connection** and click **Properties**.
Step 3: Double-click **Intel Protocol TCP/IPv4**.
Step 4: See the exact IP for your computer. Then change the **Preferred DNS server** address to match the Primary Domain Controller's IP address.



Step 5: Then click **OK** to close all windows.

Way 2: Specify the WINS Server's IP Address on the Client

If your Active Directory domain controller is also acting as a WINS server, you can set the WINS IP address to point to the WINS server (the IP address of the primary domain controller) on the client computer you want to join the domain. The steps are as follows:

Step 1: Open the Network Connections control panel. Then right-click the **local area connection** and click **Properties**.
Step 2: Double-click **Intel Protocol TCP/IPv4**. Then navigate to **Advanced > WINS > Add**.
Step 3: In the WINS server filed, type in the IP address and click **Add**. Then click **OK** to apply changes.

After that, you should now be able to join the workstation to the domain without the
“the specified domain either does not exist or could not be contacted” problem recurring.

Way 3: Change a Certain Registry Key

Modifying the value of the SysVolReady registry entry on the domain controller may resolve this issue. Since this is a registry operation, it is recommended that you back up the registry or create a system restore point as a necessary precaution. Once done, you can do the following:
Step 1: Press the **Win + R** key to open the Run box. Then type **regedit** in it and press **Enter**.
Step 2: Navigate to the following path:
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINESystemCurrentControlSetServicesNetlogonParameters
Step 3: On the right panel of the window, right-click the **SysVolReaady** entry and select the **Modify** option.
Step 4: Under the **Value data** section, change the value to **1**. Then click **OK** to save the change.

Once done, restart your computer and see if the problem is gone.